SOP-005: Extreme Weather Handling

Document ID: SOP-005

Owner: Dispatch Operations

Applies to: All dispatchers and drivers

1. Purpose

Extreme heat, storms, and snow increase the risk of temperature excursions and delays. This SOP explains how to respond.

2. Heatwaves (Outside Temperature Above 35°C)

- Reefer units work harder in heat. Check the cargo temperature of every perishable shipment in the area **every 30 minutes** instead of every hour.
- Avoid door openings. Deliveries in heatwaves should be made at loading docks with shade or cold rooms.
- If a fresh perishable shipment is already above 6°C during a heatwave, contact the driver to check the reefer settings **before** it breaches 8°C.

3. Storms, Heavy Rain, and Snow

- If the weather severity score (`weather_condition_severity`) is above **0.8**, the driver may stop at a safe location. Driver safety comes first.
- Check that the reefer unit has enough fuel for the extra waiting time.
- Treat expected delays of more than 4 hours on perishables as a **Tier 2 warning** (see SOP-002).

4. Freezing Weather (Outside Temperature Below 0°C)

- Fresh perishables can freeze. Confirm that the reefer is set to **heat mode** if the cargo drops below 2°C.